

Video Scripts — Modules 0-3

Equip2Lead Coach · Leadership Track · Dr. Denis Ekobena · 2 October 2026

How to use these scripts

These eight scripts replace the temporary "Raising Standards" clip in Modules 0–3. Each is written from the actual module text live on the platform, so what you say matches what learners read next.

#	Module	Slot	Length
1	0 — Starting Point	Welcome (idx 2)	3–4 min
2	1 — The Leader Within	Welcome (idx 2)	3 min
3	1 — The Leader Within	Section 1: Why You Must Lead Yourself First (idx 8)	2–3 min
4	1 — The Leader Within	Section 4: Emotional Intelligence (idx 228)	2–3 min
5	2 — Character in the Dark	Welcome (idx 2)	3 min
6	2 — Character in the Dark	The Three Things You Don't Touch (idx 87)	2–3 min
7	3 — Emotional Intelligence	Welcome (idx 2)	3 min
8	3 — Emotional Intelligence	Self-Regulation (idx 40)	2–3 min

Where you see **[YOUR STORY — ...]**, the words must be true and yours. A guiding question helps you find the story fast. Everything else can be read as written or adapted into your own voice.

Pace: about 130–150 words per minute, unhurried.

1. Module 0 — Welcome to Your Journey (3-4 min)

The first video every learner sees on the platform. Warm, personal, unhurried.

Welcome. I'm Denis Ekobena, and I'm glad you're here.

If you're watching this, one of two things is probably true. Either you already know you were called to lead, and you're looking for something deeper than the surface teaching most leadership content offers. Or something in your life — a role, a responsibility, a weight of influence you didn't ask for — has shown you that you need to grow.

Either way, you're in the right place.

I want to be honest with you from the start about what this is. This is not a program for people who want to sound like leaders. It's for people who want to become leaders — the kind whose influence lasts, whose character holds under pressure, and whose fruit remains long after they've left the room.

[YOUR STORY — Why did you build Equip2Lead? Think of the moment or the person that made you decide leaders in Africa and beyond needed this kind of formation. One or two minutes, told simply.]

Here's the definition this whole journey stands on: leadership is influence. It's the ability of one person to inspire, guide, and develop others toward a shared purpose. Not a title. Not a position. Not a personality type. Which means that if your words, your actions, or your example cause anyone to think, act, or become better — you are already leading. The only question is how well.

Over the next twelve modules, we'll walk through five pillars together: leading yourself, setting direction, leading people, executing with excellence, and multiplying your impact. And underneath all of it is one simple order: Know, Be, Do. You can't do what you haven't become.

One more thing before you begin. This is a slow-cooker journey, not a microwave. Real formation takes time, and it will cost you something — honesty, attention, and the willingness to look at parts of yourself you'd rather skip. That's not a warning. It's the reason it works.

So take your time with this first module. Read it slowly. And when you get to your first assignment, set your intention honestly.

I'm honoured to walk this road with you. Let's begin.

2. Module 1 — Welcome to The Leader Within (3 min)

Welcome to Module 1.

In the Starting Point, we agreed on what leadership is: influence. Now we start where all influence begins — not with your team, not with your organisation, but with you.

This module is called The Leader Within, and it's built on one uncomfortable truth: you cannot lead others further than you have learned to lead yourself. Before you give direction, before you cast vision, before you build a team, there's a quieter question. Who are you when nobody is watching?

Here's what we'll do together. We'll start with why you must lead yourself first. Then we'll ask the identity question — who am I, really — and look at the two wrong foundations most leaders build on: performance and approval. We'll walk through four pillars of self-leadership: self-awareness, self-discipline, emotional regulation, and personal accountability. And by the end, you'll write your own Self-Leadership Manifesto and build a daily, weekly, and monthly rhythm to keep it alive.

This is the longest module in the track, and that's deliberate. Everything after it stands on this foundation.

[YOUR STORY — When did you first realise that your biggest leadership challenge was yourself, not the people around you? A short, honest moment is enough.]

Give yourself about two hours across this module — roughly ninety minutes of reading and thirty for the assignment. You don't have to do it in one sitting. But don't rush the scorecard in Section 3. Answer it as you actually are, not as you hope to be.

Let's look in the mirror together.

3. Module 1, Section 1 — Why You Must Lead Yourself First (2-3 min)

There's a lie most leaders believe, and it takes years to unlearn.

The lie is that leadership is something you do to other people. You take a position, you give direction, you manage performance — and if you get better at those things, you become a better leader.

There's some truth in that. But it's not where leadership begins.

Leadership begins in a much quieter place. In how you speak to yourself when you fail. In what you do early in the morning or late at night, when no one will ever see it. In the small private choices no team meeting will ever surface.

Think about Moses and Joseph. Before either of them led a nation, God took them through long, hidden seasons — forty years in the desert for one, years in a prison for the other. Nobody was watching. That's where they were formed. The public leadership came later, and it held because the private work had already been done.

[YOUR STORY — Describe a hidden season in your own life — a time when nobody saw the work you were doing on yourself — and what it built in you that you still lean on today.]

As you read this section, you'll meet what I call the Congruence Test: is there a gap between who you are and what you say? Every leader has some gap. The question is whether it's closing or growing.

So as you read, keep one question in front of you: if the people I lead could see my private life, would it strengthen their trust in me — or weaken it?

Leadership begins with the person in the mirror. Let's start there.

4. Module 1, Section 4 — Emotional Intelligence: The Inner Edge (2-3 min)

I want to show you something that should change how you think about leadership.

Daniel Goleman, the psychologist who brought emotional intelligence to the world's attention, studied leaders across many industries. His conclusion was that most of what separates great leaders from average ones isn't intelligence or technical skill. It's emotional — how well you understand and manage yourself, and how well you read and respond to others.

Put simply: your IQ may get you hired. Your EQ is what gets you promoted — and keeps you there.

I've watched this play out more times than I can count. Pastors who could study Scripture in the original languages but couldn't hold a difficult conversation with their board. Entrepreneurs who could build a great product but couldn't stop themselves from tearing down their team. Gifted speakers who moved thousands from the stage while their own families walked on eggshells at home.

[YOUR STORY — Think of a time your own emotions led you, instead of you leading them — a meeting, a decision, a conversation you'd handle differently today. What did it cost, and what did you learn?]

Here's the good news, and it's the reason this section exists: emotional intelligence can be learned. It isn't a personality you're born with or without. It's a set of skills, and skills grow with practice.

This section gives you a first look. In Module 3, we'll go much deeper, one domain at a time. For now, as you read, just notice: when pressure rises, what happens inside you first — and what do the people around you see?

5. Module 2 — Welcome to Character in the Dark (3 min)

Welcome to Module 2.

I'll start with a sentence I want you to remember: your charisma will lift you up, but only your character will keep you there.

Those aren't the same thing, and they aren't built the same way. Charisma is what a room notices in thirty seconds. Character is what your family, your team, and your own conscience know about you after thirty years — including everything that never made it onto a stage.

That's why this module is called Character in the Dark. It's about who you are in the rooms nobody else is in.

We'll look at what qualifies a leader in Scripture — and notice what's missing from those lists: talent, charisma, credentials. We'll talk honestly about how leaders fall, and why it almost never happens in a single moment. We'll name the three things a leader must not touch. And we'll look at real leaders — some who held, and some who didn't.

[YOUR STORY — Think of a leader you knew personally whose character held under real pressure, when it would have been easy to give way. What did you see in them? No names needed if it's sensitive.]

This module isn't here to frighten you, and it isn't here to make you judge anyone. Every leader who fell once believed it could never happen to them. The point is to name your own pressure points now — and put guardrails in place before you ever need them.

Give yourself about an hour and forty minutes. And when you reach Section 5, slow down. That's the heart of this module.

Let's go into the dark together — so you can lead in the light.

6. Module 2 — The Three Things You Don't Touch (2-3 min)

This is the heart of the module, so I want to speak to you directly before you read it.

Nobody wakes up one morning and decides to fall. It happens slowly, in stages. First comparison — you measure your life against someone else's and decide you deserve what they have. Then rationalisation — the rules everyone else follows don't quite apply to you. Then isolation — you stop letting anyone close enough to ask the hard question. By then, the thing that would have saved you is already gone.

That's why I teach leaders three things they must not touch. Gold — money that isn't yours, or isn't handled transparently. Girls — or for women leaders, the same trap from the other side: sexual sin, which rarely starts with sex and usually starts with unmet emotional needs. And glory — pride, the belief that you're indispensable and above correction.

All three are quiet at first. All three feel justified from the inside. And all three have taken down leaders with more talent and more influence than most of us will ever have.

[YOUR STORY — Which of the three do you personally guard against most carefully, and what is one concrete guardrail you've put in place? Being specific here gives your learners permission to be honest too.]

As you read, you'll come to a list of eight enemies of the heart. Don't skim it. Ask yourself one hard question: which of these has the most access to me?

That one — the one you'd rather not name — is the one to guard first. And the best guardrail of all is simple: someone in your life with permission to ask you the hard question, and the freedom to hear the true answer.

7. Module 3 — Welcome to Emotional Intelligence (3 min)

Welcome to Module 3.

In Module 1, you got a first look at emotional intelligence. In Module 2, you did the hard character work. Now we bring the two together and ask a more practical question: can you actually read and manage what's happening inside you — in real time, under pressure, not just in principle?

Emotional intelligence can sound soft. The research behind it isn't. And the cost of lacking it is very real: the leader who loses control in public loses authority immediately. People stop hearing what you say and start managing your mood instead.

This module walks through five domains, one at a time: self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, and social skills. You'll meet leaders who got it right and leaders who got it badly wrong — from a Roman emperor who built his calm deliberately, night after night, to a modern CEO whose second reaction did more damage than his first.

[YOUR STORY — Which of the five domains came naturally to you, and which one have you had to work hardest to build? Tell it honestly — learners need to see that even experienced leaders have a weak domain.]

By the end, you'll name your own weakest domain. Not the one you'd guess — the one your patterns actually reveal. And you'll leave with one concrete practice to strengthen it.

Give yourself about seventy to eighty minutes. And here's one piece of advice: don't rush past the sections that feel obvious. Those are often the ones worth the most attention.

Let's begin.

8. Module 3 — Self-Regulation (2-3 min)

You've just read about a leader whose failure wasn't the first thing he said. It was what he did after — reposting the very words that caused the harm, instead of pausing long enough to hear what had landed wrong.

That's the part of self-regulation most leaders miss. It's not only about your first reaction. Everyone has a bad moment. It's about whether you can regulate the second one — the reply, the defence, the email you send at midnight to prove you were right.

And this isn't a new problem. As you'll read next, Marcus Aurelius, who ruled Rome for nearly two decades, admitted in his private notebook that he struggled with a quick temper. He wasn't born calm. He built it, night after night, reviewing his day: where he'd lost his temper, where he'd let someone else's behaviour decide his own.

He had the power to do almost anything he wanted. And he still concluded that rage is weakness dressed up as authority.

[YOUR STORY — Tell about a moment when you caught yourself before a second reaction — the reply you didn't send, the word you held back — and what changed because you paused. Or, if it's more honest, a time you didn't pause and what it cost.]

Here's a simple practice to start this week. Before you respond to anything that stings — an email, a comment, a decision you disagree with — wait. Even ten minutes. Then ask one question: what do I want this relationship to look like a year from now? Respond from there.

Calm isn't the absence of strength. It's what strength looks like under provocation.

Recording order and handoff

Record the Module 0 welcome first: every learner sees it, and it replaces the most visible "temporary" label on the platform.

- **Session 1 — the four welcomes** (Modules 0, 1, 2, 3). Same warm energy, about 13 minutes of finished video.
- **Session 2 — the four section videos** (Module 1 §1 and §4, Module 2 Three Things, Module 3 Self-Regulation). More reflective, about 10 minutes.

After recording:

- ☐ Upload each video to YouTube (unlisted is fine)
- ☐ Title each one clearly, e.g. "Module 0 — Welcome | Denis Ekobena"
- ☐ Send the links in chat with the script number (1-8) for each

Claude Code then swaps each link into its slot and removes the "temporary placeholder" titles.